

STAND FIRM. SPEND YOUR LIFE WELL.

1 Corinthians 15:58

REFLECTION | HEAD - HEART - HANDS

What does Paul's mystery teach about our future? How does Christ's victory address my fears today? What work of the Lord is God calling me to abound in now?

INVITATION QUESTION

If death has already lost the final battle, what would you attempt for Christ if you were no longer governed by the fear that your labor might be wasted?

WITNESSING STATEMENT

Christians can face death differently because Jesus Christ walked out of the grave - and He has promised that death will not have the final word.

MEMORY VERSE | 1 CORINTHIANS 15:58

Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that in the Lord your labor is not in vain.

ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY

Death has already lost the battle. Stand firm and spend your life on work that resurrection makes eternal.

Because Christ lives, faithful labor is never wasted.

PRE-SERMON TEACHING BOOKLET | 9.6.26

THE MYSTERY AND THE VICTORY

1 Corinthians 15:50-58 | Brian Tarpy

BIG IDEA

Because Christ has conquered death, every believer will be transformed, death itself will be defeated, and our work for the Lord is never wasted.

THE PASSAGE IN ONE MOVEMENT

Our present bodies cannot inherit the imperishable Kingdom. At the last trumpet, God will transform His people, swallow up death in victory, and call us to steadfast service.

GOVERNING KINGDOM PRINCIPLE

The King's resurrection victory guarantees both our future transformation and the eternal significance of faithful Kingdom work today.

KEY SCRIPTURES TO STUDY

- Romans 8:17, 23
- Philippians 3:20-21
- 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17
- John 5:28-29
- Isaiah 25:8
- Revelation 21:4

Be ready to teach. Be ready to disciple. Be ready to stand.

THE MYSTERY: WE WILL BE CHANGED

1 Corinthians 15:50-53

1. OUR PRESENT BODIES CANNOT INHERIT THE KINGDOM | v. 50

Flesh and blood in their present perishable condition are not suited for the imperishable Kingdom.

2. GOD REVEALS A MYSTERY | v. 51

Not every Christian will experience physical death, but every Christian will be changed.

3. THE TRANSFORMATION WILL BE SUDDEN AND COMPLETE | vv. 52-53

At the last trumpet, the dead will be raised imperishable and the living transformed. Mortality must put on immortality.

THEOLOGICAL THEMES

- Resurrection of the body;
- God's sovereign mystery;
- new creation and transformation;
- hope and eternal life;
- identity and destiny in Christ;
- God's faithfulness to His promises.

We shall not merely survive. In Christ, we shall be transformed.

DEATH IS SWALLOWED UP

1 Corinthians 15:54-58

4. DEATH WILL BE SWALLOWED UP IN VICTORY | v. 54

Resurrection is more than our survival. It is the fulfillment of God's promised conquest of death.

5. CHRIST REMOVES DEATH'S STING | vv. 55-57

Sin gives death its sting, and the law exposes and condemns sin. But God gives His people victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.

6. RESURRECTION TRUTH PRODUCES RESURRECTION LIVING | v. 58

Therefore: be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord.

GOSPEL FOCUS

Jesus did not merely teach us how to face death. He entered death, conquered it through His resurrection, and shares His victory with those who belong to Him.

KINGDOM APPLICATION

Kingdom work done today has eternal significance. We labor faithfully because the King who defeated death will raise His people and complete His Kingdom purposes.

APPLICATION SCENARIOS FOR EVERYDAY LIFE

At home: love and encourage with resurrection hope. At work or school: labor with integrity for eternal impact. In the community: speak with courage and hope. In the church: serve joyfully and faithfully. In discipleship: live with eternal perspective, purity, and dependence on Christ.

Death has already lost the battle.

APPLICATION | PREPARE TO HEAR AND RESPOND